

Leave Us Hope So

CHET NELSON, THE DENVER sports editor, greeted a Richmonder in Philadelphia with some cheering, if true, news.

"This will be Richmond's year with the Yankees," said Nelson. "Last season the Yankees favored our club. Now it's Richmond's turn to get the Yankees' top prospects."

Nelson believes the tip-off on the Virginians being the Yankees' No. 1 triple-A farm club this season was the appointment of Andy Cohen as the managerial successor to Ralph Houk at Denver when Houk was made a Yankee coach.

"Cohen is not a Yankee-system man," Nelson explained. "He'd been a highly successful and popular manager of our class A club in the Western League before we entered the American Association. When we obtained a triple-A working agreement with the Yankees, the New York club sent in its own man, Houk, to manage. Since Eddie Lopat is a member of the Yankee organization, and Cohen is not, one has to figure Richmond is now the Yankees' No. 1 triple-A club."

Leave us hope, then, the acquisition of Rance Pless by the Virginians was just the first of several Yankee-manipulated deals favoring the Vees.

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